Public Management Review

ISSN: (Print) (Online) Journal homepage: www.tandfonline.com/journals/rpxm20

# How has stakeholder theory served the public administration literature? In search of the intellectual structure of the field

Ricardo Corrêa Gomes, Erika Lisboa, Greici Sartury & Gustavo Mirapalheta

**To cite this article:** Ricardo Corrêa Gomes, Erika Lisboa, Greici Sartury & Gustavo Mirapalheta (12 Mar 2024): How has stakeholder theory served the public administration literature? In search of the intellectual structure of the field, Public Management Review, DOI: 10.1080/14719037.2024.2323170

**To link to this article:** https://doi.org/10.1080/14719037.2024.2323170

Published online: 12 Mar 2024.

Submit your article to this journal

Article views: 248

View related articles

View Crossmark data

Full Terms & Conditions of access and use can be found at
https://www.tandfonline.com/action/journalInformation?journalCode=rpxm20

PUBLIC MANAGEMENT REVIEW
https://doi.org/10.1080/14719037.2024.2323170

Routledge
Taylor & Francis Group

Check for updates

# How has stakeholder theory served the public administration literature? In search of the intellectual structure of the field

Ricardo Corrêa Gomes[a], Erika Lisboa[a], Greici Sartury[b] and Gustavo Mirapalheta[a]

[a]Public Management Department, Escola de Administração de Empresas – Fundação Getulio Vargas (FGV EAESP), São Paulo, Brazil; [b]Business Department, Universidade Federal de Santa Maria (UFSM), Santa Maria, Brazil

**ABSTRACT**
This investigation aims to contribute to the intellectual structure of public administration stakeholder theory. There is a need for dedicated effort to understand the real contribution of the most cited references in the field. The literature review is carried out using bibliometric and lexical analyses. The main conclusion is that articles have used concepts from four theoretical bases: collaborative governance, stakeholder salience, legitimacy, and wicked policy problems. This represents a step forward in the existing literature on public administration stakeholder theory extant literature as we advocate the return to using stakeholders to explain performance determinants.

**ARTICLE HISTORY** Received 9 June 2023; Revised 22 December 2023; Accepted 20 February 2024

**KEYWORDS** Stakeholder theory; public administration; literature review; bibliometric analysis; kernel canonical correlation analysis

## Introduction

The term stakeholder has been used in public administration articles since 1982, two years before Robert Edward Freeman published his landmark book 'Strategic Management: A Stakeholder Approach'. This book is regarded as one of the most influential in the stakeholder theory field. Despite being developed for the business sector, stakeholder theory is useful in the public sector, as demonstrated by several scholars. For example, Bryson (2018) argued about the importance of satisfying stakeholders according to their criteria and improving the odds of a public organization being able to enhance organizational legitimacy. For this reason, it is crucial to develop techniques and theories to improve managerial skills in identifying the most influential stakeholders and understanding their expectations from the organization. Therefore, in this article, we assess how the term stakeholder has been used in the public administration literature by investigating which references have influenced the field to date.

We researched the literature using the term stakeholder in the Clarivate Web of Science (WoS) database, focusing on the Public Administration Web of Science

**CONTACT** Ricardo Corrêa Gomes Ricardo.Gomes@fgv.br
© 2024 Informa UK Limited, trading as Taylor & Francis Group

category, articles, early-view articles, and documents written in English. Our systematic literature review is carried out using the Bibliometrix package in RStudio. In this study, we joined forces with a few articles that tried to depict the importance of stakeholder theory to public organizations. For example, Beck and Storopoli (2021, 3) searched the Elsevier Scopus database to identify the mainstream literature on stakeholder theory in the urban context. Although using stakeholder theory, their work is confined to urban context and urban management, not touching on other public management aspects. Pedrini and Ferri (2019) is another systematic literature review study that uses stakeholder theory but with a broader scope (besides public administration) and focuses on stakeholder management, relationships, and engagement. Therefore, it does not touch on public administration knowledge production. Gomes et al. (2020) used a systematic literature review to uncover how essential stakeholder influences on local government performance. It is, therefore, confined to local government, disregarding other levels of government and types of public organizations. More recently, Sarturi et al. (2023, 2) have conducted a bibliometric analysis aiming 'to analyze how stakeholder theory has been studied in the public sector domain'. The difference between their work and ours is the type of analysis they carried out and their main results. While they used citation and co-citation, stopping at a list of the most relevant articles, we used lexical analysis to identify similarities between the ten most relevant cited documents and how they supported theory building. Summarizing, the main difference between these studies and ours is that, while they commendably depicted the literature and demonstrated theoretical and methodological gaps, we focused on trying to understand in detail the intellectual structure of the stakeholder theory and public administration for, in so doing, identify research gaps in the literature. Therefore, our article delves into the articles' interiors, looking for evidence about how the intellectual structure is constructed. For this reason, this article aims to answer the question of what the intellectual structure that formed the production of the public administration stakeholder theory is.

The research was carried out in September 2023, when we found 2,369 articles (almost five hundred more than Sarturi, Barakat, and Gomes 2023). The literature review is done twofold: a bibliometric analysis to depict the most relevant authors, sources, themes, and cited references and a lexical examination of how the most relevant cited references (CR) have guided the production. While bibliometry is quantitative and based on co-citation and co-occurrence analysis, the content analysis searches the context in which the CR was included in the documents. Lexical analysis is carried out with co-citation, measuring how often a reference is cited by two or more articles, and co-occurrence, counting how many times words are used in titles, keywords, and abstracts. It is beneficial for creating networks and word clouds (Aria and Cuccurullo 2017). Co-citation helps depict the intellectual structure by identifying the seminal works that influenced the field with their ideas (Vogel and Güttel 2013; Zupic and Čater 2015). To determine where and how the CR was included in documents, we used Quanteda and Text Mining Packages in RStudio. Finally, we used the Kernel Canonical Correlation Analysis (KCCA) to assess the degree of similarities between the ten most cited references.

Besides this introduction, the article has a section to depict the stakeholder theory's central tenets, a section to present the data collection and analysis protocols, and one section to present the main bibliometric and content analysis findings. After that, a section covers the production in the public administration WoS category, where the

primary references are presented and discussed. Finally, a conclusion section presents the main findings, limitations, and avenues for further investigations to improve the use of such essential theories in public administration.

## Theoretical basis

The word stakeholder first appeared in 'an internal memorandum at the Stanford Research Institute in 1963', referring to 'those groups without whose support the organization would cease to exist' (Freeman 1984, 31). Stakeholder theory comes in hand with the strategic management effort to make organizations more aware of the sources of threats and opportunities posed by the environment in which they operate. Stakeholder theory became relevant to the management literature due to its power to identify the external actors likely to influence decision-making (Freeman 1984), as well as those that provide legitimacy for the organization to survive and prosper (DiMaggio and Powell 1983; Meyer and Rowan 1977; Selznick 1966). The main idea is that the organization depends on its relationships with people, groups, organizations, and the government, which have power over resources and are entitled to make the game's rules. Trying to pinpoint stakeholders, Freeman (1984, 46) proposed a broader definition: 'A stakeholder in an organization is (by definition) any group or individual who can affect or is affected by the achievement of the organization's objectives'. Intending to improve the stakeholder theory, Bryson (2018, 27) defined a stakeholder as 'any person, group, or organization that can place a claim on an organization's attention, resources, or output or is affected by that output'. The summary of the two definitions is placed on the dyadic relationship formed between organizations and stakeholders where there would be reciprocity and responsibilities (Rowley 1997).

Freeman's ideas were based on the dimensions of power and interest to classify the stakeholders that deserve the organization's attention in its strategic planning. To contribute to this point, Mitchell et al. (1997) advocated that interest could be better classified into its levels of urgency and if the stakeholder has the legitimacy to pose a claim upon the organization. In their Vein Diagram, they proposed that the stakeholder deserves more organizational attention due to power, urgency, and legitimacy levels. After this time, many tools were developed to help public and private organizations map out their stakeholders, trying to manage their power and interests to mitigate threats and increase opportunities. Ackermann and Eden (2011) started from the power-interest grid to propose a grid based on different levels of both. They suggested that stakeholders with higher power and interest are players 'who deserve sustained attention' from the organization (Ackermann and Eden 2011, 183).

Stakeholder theory has been used in the public sector's stakeholder analysis version. It is a tool to identify the actors likely to be regarded as an issue in public organizatations strategic planning process (Bryson 2004, 2018). This tool has been used in several studies focusing on public organizations because it allows to link political rationality with technical rationality (Bryson, Cunningham, and Lokkesmoe 2002) and also because not taking stakeholder concerns into account 'too often and predictably leads to poor performance outright failure or even disaster' (Bryson 2004, 23). Regarding research loci, stakeholder theory has demonstrated usefulness in local government studies (Gomes et al. 2010) and central governments (Drori and Weizmann 2007). It has been used in public management but also in other areas of public policy: climate change (Yeleliere et al. 2022), gender gap (Benigno, Vieira, and de Oliveira 2021), integration of migrants in social systems

(Huang and Han 2022), achieving Sustainable Development Goals (Rahman 2021), and disaster resilience analysis (Al-Manji, Lovett, and Mitchell 2021), among others. Therefore, stakeholder theory can identify the most relevant interested parties whom public organizations must include in their decisions and policy-making if they intend to succeed. Although acknowledging the applicability of the theory to the public sector, there is still room to improve it to be a better fit for the complexity of this type of organization compared with the private sector.

## Literature review methods

This investigation aims to review the literature to depict the mainstream documents that have helped build the intellectual structure of the public administration stakeholder theory. To this end, we use a literature review that combines bibliometric methods with lexical analysis. Bibliometric analysis helps to transform a huge volume of data into simple constructs and diagrams (Aria and Cuccurullo 2017). Content analysis is a technique for reducing a large amount of textual data into fewer categories (Zaidman-Zait 2014). In so doing, we use Zupic and Čater (2015, 433) framework for bibliometric methods and content analysis of the most relevant references to identify how public administration articles have used stakeholder ideas as theoretical support. The Zupic and Čater framework comprises a workflow of five steps: research design, compilation of bibliographic data, analysis, visualization, and interpretation.

### *Step 1: research design*

Data is collected from the Clarivate Web of Science database. Besides depicting the most relevant information about the dataset (authors, sources, most cited articles, countries, and annual production), we used the field Cited References (CR) to identify the documents that support the intellectual structure. Co-citation analysis and co-occurrence network are used to identify the most relevant documents in the intellectual structure (Vogel and Güttel 2013; Zupic and Čater 2015). The whole bibliometric analysis is carried out using Aria and Cuccurullo's ideas, which they transformed into an interface for RStudio. After selecting the most relevant (highly cited) CR, the full articles are scanned using a tool in RStudio to transform PDF into textual data.

### *Step 2: compilation of bibliometric data*

We collected data in the Clarivate Web of Science database (WoS), which is regarded as the most comprehensive database (Baminiwatta and Solangaarachchi 2021). We used the term 'stakeholder' as a query topic (titles, abstracts, and keywords), focusing on the Public Administration WoS category and restricting the search to English language documents. We used only peer-reviewed articles in the query to ensure the quality of the pieces. Data were downloaded in the 'BibTeX' format and dealt with using the Bibliometrix package of the RStudio Software, where it can be merged, sorted out, and cleaned, as WoS does not allow downloading more than 500 references at the time.

### Step 3: analysis

The analysis is carried out using Bibliometrix software in RStudio. We scanned the literature twofold, using bibliometric and content analysis. Bibliometric analysis helps depict the most relevant authors, sources, and production over time. According to Zupic and Čater (2015), there are five types of bibliometric analysis: 1) citation, 2) co-citation, 3) bibliographic coupling, 4) co-author, and 5) co-word. The analysis that helps in identifying the most relevant authors is co-citation, defined by Zupic and Čater (2015, 432) as the process of connecting 'documents, authors, or journals on the basis of joint appearances in reference lists'. It is also labelled as the intellectual structure (Beck and Storopoli 2021) because it allows 'tracing the intellectual roots of an academic field through the identification of its foundational works' (Vogel and Güttel 2013). There are two ways to identify the most cited references in Bibliometrix: 1) three-field plot and 2) co-citation network.

In the co-citation analysis, data is analysed as networks where the main information is the centrality of a node (Leydesdorff 2007). The most relevant centrality measures are PageRank, Betweenness, and Closeness, which are all measures to assess the influence of a given object in a network (Liu et al. 2005). PageRank was primarily used in Google Search, and it 'works on the premise that the importance of any Web page can be judged by the pages that link to it' (Ding et al. 2009, 2229). Betweenness is defined as 'the distance of an actor from all other actors in a network' (Leydesdorff 2007, 1304). This measure operationalizes the expected reach of a communication. Centrality, in turn, is defined as 'the extent that the actor is positioned on the shortest path . . . between other pairs of actors in the network' (Leydesdorff 2007, 1304). The Bibliometrix algorithm provides these measures.

After deciding upon the most representative references, we carry out a content analysis using the authors' names as codes in the articles in which they appear in the CR metadata. The process is carried out according to this protocol: i) using a Three-Field plot, it is possible to detect the ten most relevant CRs; ii) using co-citation analysis, it is possible, through network parameters, to confirm the ten most relevant and to identify those with the highest number of citations; iii) using the search tool in Microsoft Excel it is possible to identify the articles that have used CR in their reference lists; iv) downloading PDF files; v) using pdftools package in RStudio, it is possible to extract textual data from the PDF files; vi) using Quanteda or TM (texting mining) packages, it is possible to break the textual data into corpora, then into tokens; vii) after that, the command kwic, which stands for locate keywords-in-context, search the CR first author's name and the context in which it appears. The command is (kwic (total_tokens, 'term_of_interest', window = 5), and it allows identifying the term of interest in the list of corpora and the words in its surroundings. The window command defines how many words to the right or to the left you want to analyse; viii) finally, the result of the kwic search is transformed to csv format to be analysed in MSExcel, where data can be organized, ordered and separated out in clusters.

### Step 4: visualisation

Biblioshiny is an interface recommended for citation analysis as it provides a good visual for the networks and a table of all the parameters needed to understand the

network parameters. It is now a matter of making the relationship clearer and unequivocal. To facilitate the use of the RStudio package for those unfamiliar with programming in R, Massimo Aria and Corrado Cuccurullo have developed this interface, which is installed with the Bibliometrix package.

### *Step 5: interpretation of the findings*

The final step is to analyse the content of the ten most cited references. The process is carried out by comparing a clean version of the articles to identify commonalities. The clean version of the articles does not have stopwords. The correlation analysis is carried out using only nouns, verbs and adjectives. A thorough description of how we have done this process will be provided in Section 5.

## Findings

### *Public administration stakeholder theory bibliometric analysis*

#### *Characteristics of the database*

We consulted the WoS on 8 September 2023. The outcome of the query was 2,369 documents. After opening the dataset in the Biblioshiny interface, we detected that books, book chapters, and conference papers were mixed with articles and early view articles. We removed them from the analysis to ensure that the protocol was followed by including only articles in the analysis. We found 2,046 articles from 1982 to 2023 published in 86 sources with an Annual Growth Rate of 13.53%. These documents have an average of citations per document of 19.74 and an average citation per document year of 2.094. They used 89,145 references. The articles used 2,603 Keywords Plus (ID) and 4,755 Author's Keywords (DE). Figure 1 indicates the production annual production. The production peaked in 2022 when 228 articles were published. Another curiosity of the database is the number of authors that have published a single article, representing 86% of the total. This finding contradicts

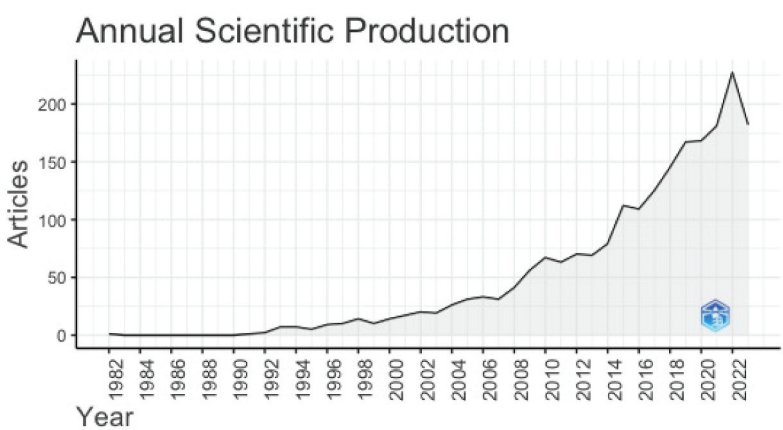


Figure 1. Annual production. Source: Data Analysis.

Lotka's Law coefficient estimation, which defines this number as around 60% (Thompson and Walker 2015).

The first article was published in 1982 by Lawrence and Cook (1982) to depict stakeholders' views about policy programmes. According to them, stakeholders are '. . . those who pay for, carry out, or receive program services' Lawrence and Cook (1982, 120). This finding is very interesting as the term stakeholder was used in Freeman's landmark book written two years later. Colebrook and Dennison (1991) published the second article almost ten years later. In this article, the authors researched the 'collective bargain process in fourteen unionized colleges in British Columbia' (Colebrook and Dennison 1991, 1). They used the term stakeholder to characterize the primary sources of information for their investigation. After that, more articles were published, as demonstrated in Figure 1. After 1997, we observed more than ten articles per year. This number was over 100 in 2018, reaching the highest value in 2022.

### *Most relevant sources*

The most relevant sources provide two insights for researchers: where to send your article and where to start your research for theoretical support. The two analyses are the source's production over time and the Bradford Law. Table 1 presents the most relevant sources regarding the total of articles published. The most relevant is the Climate Policy (JCR 6.056), a journal classified in the Environmental Studies and Public Administration WoS categories. The second most influential is Science and Public Policy (JCR 2.087), a journal dedicated to environmental studies, management, and public administration. The third most relevant is PAR (JCR 8.144), which is solely dedicated to public administration. Among the ten most relevant sources, seven are solely dedicated to public administration, and three are dedicated to environmental studies besides public administration.

Figure 2 presents Bradford's Law, which, according to Wagner-Döbler (1996), is a solution to the problem of reducing the scope of the analysis to a certain number of journals that concentrate on the most significant number of articles in the field. Bradford's Law is equivalent to the Pareto distribution, which is based on the assumption that 'the 80/20 ratio (80% of use is derived from 20% of the titles)' (Nisonger 2008, 62). As demonstrated in Figure 4, the grey rectangle at the left side of the chart indicates the sources where the production is concentrated and where the literature review shall be started.

**Table 1.** Most relevant sources.

| Sources | Articles |
|---|---|
| (1) Climate Policy | 119 |
| (2) Science And Public Policy | 96 |
| (3) Public Administration Review | 92 |
| (4) Journal Of Public Affairs | 85 |
| (5) Public Money & Management | 85 |
| (6) Public Management Review | 81 |
| (7) International Review of Administrative Sciences | 76 |
| (8) Public Administration | 68 |
| (9) Environment And Planning C-Government and Policy | 58 |
| (10) International Journal of Public Administration | 53 |

Source: Data Analysis.

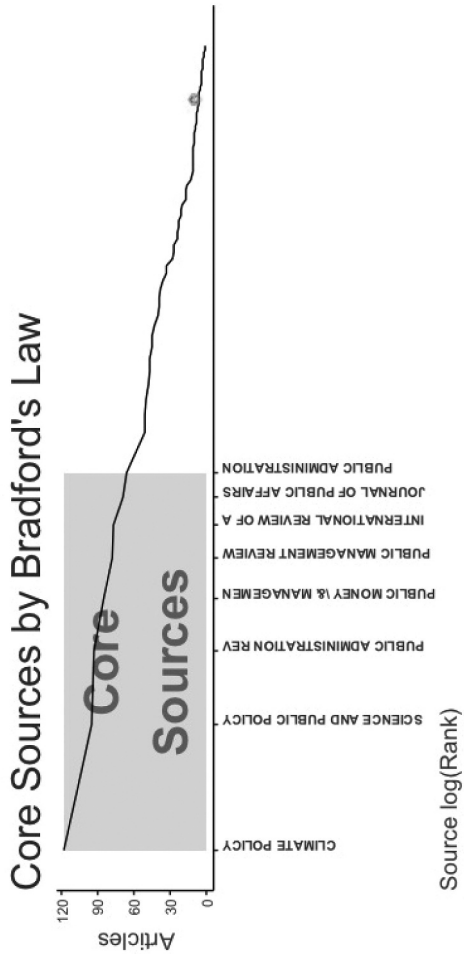


**Figure 2.** Core sources according to the Bradford Law. Source: Data Analysis.

### *Most relevant Cited References (CR)*

The most relevant references are analysed using the Bibliometrix package for the most cited reference tool. Table 3 indicates the eleven most cited documents, or those cited 50 times or more. Besides acknowledging the importance of books, we preferred to do the analysis focusing on articles because we will analyse the whole PDF document. Including books in the sample would unbalance the number of pages and the lexical analysis based on frequency and occurrence. The citation analysis is also used to demonstrate the documents that help to form the intellectual structure, as indicated in Figure 3. The most cited reference is by Ansell and Gash (2008), who wrote a theoretical article proposing a model for collaborative governance. The second most cited is Emerson et al. (2012), who, like Ansell and Gash (2008), published another theoretical article to propose an integrative framework for collaborative governance. The third most cited article is Mitchell et al. (1997), which is acknowledged as a more comprehensive framework for stakeholder analysis. The fourth most cited reference is DiMaggio and Powell (1983), a classic article in the field of sociology that deals with new institutionalism. The sequence follows with Bryson et al. (2006), a piece dedicated to cross-sector collaboration; Bingham et al. (2005), another article dedicated to governance and citizen's participation; Rittel and Webber (1973) and their work with solutions for wicked policy problems; Arnstein (1969), an article dedicated to explaining the situations and context of citizens' participation in decision-making; Suchman (1995), who synthesized a large literature on legitimacy; Bryson (2004) with his collection of stakeholder analysis tools; and, finally, Provan and Kenis (2007) who contributed to the governance of network effectiveness.

Using co-citation analysis, there is evidence that Ansell and Gash's (2008) influence on the field is clear. Relevance is measured according to the reference capacity to generate citations. Bibliometrix uses Betweenness, Closeness and PageRank to measure relevance. In these indexes, Ansell & Gash has the highest levels in Betweenness and PageRank, 148.47 and 0.07. The second most relevant is in the PageRank criteria with 0.054. As PageRank measures the number of connections pointing to a particular reference, this is the most reliable indicator to measure relevance in terms of co-citation. Relevance can be seen in Figure 3 by eyeballing the size of the nodes and the number of connections among them, indicating their relevance to public administration intellectual structure.

## How have authors influenced the public administration stakeholder theory (PAST)?

We departed from the most relevant CR indicated in Table 2. We downloaded the eleven PDFs and concentrated the analysis using several packages in Rstudio, but the most relevant are the Quanteda family (quanteda, textplot, textstat, and textmodels), Tidyverse family (ggplot, dplyr, tidyr, stringr, and tidytext) alongside the text mining package (TM) and pdftools. PDF files are transformed into corpora, tokens, and dfm (Benoit et al. 2018). We used the customary cleaning process to remove stopwords, symbols, numbers, and other characters that could bias the lexical analysis. The main idea is to keep only nouns, verbs, and adjectives. Additionally, we refrain from using stemming mechanisms for having a set of complete words and not roots. After cleaning, data is transformed into vectors, datasets composed of features (documents and words) and frequencies (the number of times they appear in a given document). With these procedures, we calculated

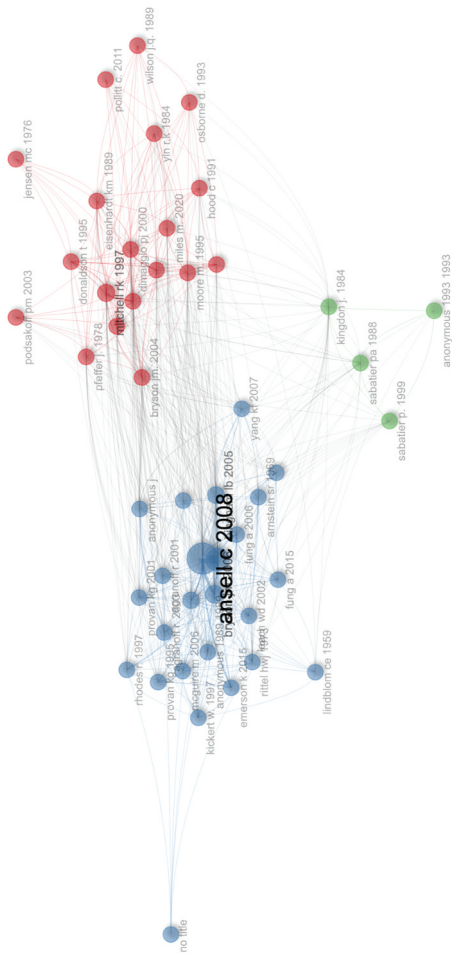


Figure 3. Co-citation network. Source: Data Analysis.

**Table 2.** The most sources of information for stakeholder studies in public administration.

| CR | Total citations | Objective | Method | Contribution for stakeholder theory |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Ansell and Gash (2008) | 134 | contingency model of collaborative governance | meta-analysis | incentives for stakeholders to participate in consensus-oriented decision-making |
| Emerson et al. (2012) | 80 | conceptual frameworks for integrative collaborative governance. | literature review | framework for a conceptual map for exploring components of cross-boundary governance systems |
| Mitchell et al. (1997) | 79 | theory of stakeholder identification and salience | literature review | power, legitimacy, and urgency as dimensions of stakeholders salience |
| DiMaggio and Powell (1983) | 68 | describing why organizations become similar after transformations | literature review | dependence between organizations and resource and legitimacy providers. |
| Bryson, Crosby and Stone (2006) | 58 | cross-sector collaboration and propositions to guide cross-sector collaborations. | literature review | Cross-sector collaborations are more likely to succeed when their planning makes use of stakeholder analyses, emphasizes responsiveness to key stakeholders |
| Bingham et al. (2005) | 57 | governance involves not simply tools but also practices and processes for people to participate. | document analysis | teaching and research to help the public sector develop and use in-formed best practices |
| Rittel and Webber (1973) | 52 | contributions to wicked policy problems | opinion | ideas of information about power and interest in sollutions for wicked policy problems |
| Arnstein (1969) | 51 | offering a typology of citizen participation | case studies | ladder pattern to depict citizens'power in determining plans and/or programs |
| Suchman (1995) | 51 | synthesis of the large literature on organizational legitimacy | literature review | concepts and tenets of legitimacy |
| Bryson (2004) | 50 | stakeholder identification and analysis | literature review | reviewing a range of stakeholder identification and analysis techniques |
| Provan & Kenis (2008) | 50 | governance of organizational networks and the impact of governance on network effectiveness | literature review | networks use resources provided by member organizations as well as external stakeholders |

Source: Data Analysis.

the term frequency of each word in each document. This way, it was possible to determine the correlation between each pair of term-frequency document vectors, creating their correlation matrix. This matrix can be seen in Table 3. The type of correlation we use is Kernel Canonical Correlation Analysis (KCCA). This type of correlation allows for assessing statistical association between variables in multiple dimensions (Vinokourov, Cristianini, and Shawe-Taylor 2002). In our case, the variables are bi-dimensional: features and frequencies. In this way, we can compare the frequency of certain words in two different articles.

According to the correlation analysis, there is convergence about the articles' influence on the public administration stakeholder theory. To specify the association level between articles, we used the following scale: 0 to 0.2 (very weak correlation); 0.2 to 0.4 (weak correlation); 0.4 to 0.6 (moderate correlation); 0.6 to 0.8 (strong correlation); and 0.8 to 1.0 (very strong correlation) (Hair and Babin 2018). We assumed that

**Table 3.** Correlation analysis among the most recurrent terms.

| | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 | 11 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| (1) Ansell and Gash (2008) | 1.000 | | | | | | | | | | |
| (2) Arnstein (1969) | 0.304 | 1.000 | | | | | | | | | |
| (3) Bingham et al. (2005) | 0.625 | 0.267 | 1.000 | | | | | | | | |
| (4) Bryson (2004) | 0.666 | 0.415 | 0.697 | 1.000 | | | | | | | |
| (5) Bryson et al. (2006) | 0.669 | 0.269 | 0.839 | 0.688 | 1.000 | | | | | | |
| (6) DiMaggio and Powell (1983) | 0.010 | 0.059 | 0.008 | 0.050 | 0.170 | 1.000 | | | | | |
| (7) Emerson et al. (2012) | 0.630 | 0.131 | 0.703 | 0.616 | 0.735 | 0.030 | 1.000 | | | | |
| (8) Mitchell et al. (1997) | 0.296 | 0.566 | 0.029 | 0.403 | 0.164 | 0.143 | 0.269 | 1.000 | | | |
| (9) Provan and Kenis (2007) | 0.342 | −0.020 | 0.328 | 0.293 | 0.438 | 0.247 | 0.457 | 0.166 | 1.000 | | |
| (10) Rittel and Webber (1973) | 0.276 | 0.176 | 0.209 | 0.102 | 0.229 | 0.067 | 0.192 | 0.141 | 0.099 | 1.000 | |
| (11) Suchman (1995) | 0.133 | −0.077 | −0.030 | 0.164 | 0.169 | 0.740 | 0.133 | 0.244 | 0.319 | 0.083 | 1.000 |

Source: Data Analysis.

a pair of strong correlations would likely indicate a theoretical cluster, as those authors have used similar patterns of words in their articles. The combination is presented in Figure 4 at the end of the next section. According to our analysis, the public administration stakeholder theory (PAST) has been developed with the contribution of four different theoretical bodies: collaborative governance, stakeholder salience, stakeholder legitimacy, and wicked policy problems.

## The intellectual structure and possible gaps

### *Collaborative governance*

The collaborative governance cluster has received relevant contributions from six articles, namely Ansell and Gash (2008), Bingham et al. (2005), Bryson (2004), Bryson et al. (2006), Emerson et al. (2012), and Provan and Kenis (2007). This last reference is included due to its moderate correlation with two of the other references in the block. There is a strong correlation between the five articles and a very strong correlation between Bingham et al. (2005) and Bryson et al. (2006), indicating that these authors have emphasized similar words in their articles. Collaborative governance is defined as

> A governing arrangement where one or more public agencies directly engage non-state stakeholders in a collective decision-making process that is formal, consensus-oriented, and deliberative and that aims to make or implement public policy or manage public programs or assets. (Ansell and Gash 2008, 544)

Another definition of collaborative governance is 'the processes and structures of public policy decision making and management that engage people constructively across the boundaries of public agencies . . . in order to carry out a public purpose that could not otherwise be accomplished' (Emerson, Nabatchi, and Balogh 2012, 2). Both definitions highlight the need to involve and engage stakeholders in implementing policies. Bryson et al. (2006) use similar literature to propose a solution for complex public problems. The difference between the latter and the former is that the term governance is not applied to

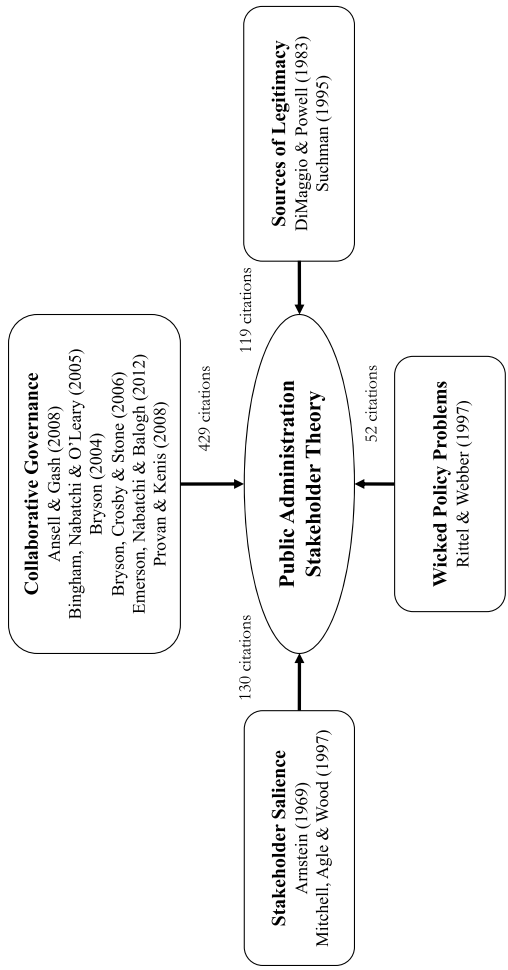


**Figure 4.** Intellectual structure theoretical framework. Source: Data Analysis.

the whole process but only to one segment related to structure, as Figure 1 (page 45) indicates. The combination of these three authors proposes theoretical grounds for studies involving collaborative initiatives in the public sector because they define the stakeholders' role and the causal relationship between stakeholder participation and public policy effectiveness. Interestingly, the articles propose theoretical frameworks with the best conditions for collaborative governance to happen.

Another article with a strong correlation with the collaborative governance block is Bryson (2004). This article was developed to strengthen the need to identify the necessary stakeholders to be invited to decision and policy-making processes. Grounded on the ambiguity of the definition provided by Freeman (1984), Bryson (2004) proposes several stakeholder analysis tools based on the assumption we don't know who we need to invite if we don't know who they are and how they matter to help 'organizations meet their mandates, fulfil their missions and create public value' (Bryson 2004, 21). Finally, Bingham et al. (2005) adopt the new public governance perspective to advocate the need to include citizens and stakeholders (isn't a citizen a stakeholder?) to participate in public administration decisions, indicating a myriad of roles they can play in the process: interest group, consumer, voter, client and citizen.

Summing up the contributions this block provided to PAST, it provided a theoretical framework indicating that effective public policies and actions need to be developed to ensure fair participation of the whole set of stakeholders having space to participate not only legitimizing the process but with the power to make and alter decisions in consensus with public agents. We also know collaboration only happens with some spontaneous combustion, as several initial preconditions must be fulfilled. Another condition is leadership, which needs to be facilitative, formal, and driving the whole process.

### *Stakeholder salience*

The second theoretical block is formed by two articles, Arnstein (1969) and Mitchell et al. (1997), which deal with stakeholder salience. The former proposes a typology 'arranged in a ladder pattern with each rung corresponding to the extent of citizens' power in determining the plan and/or program' (Arnstein 1969, 216). The ladder comprises eight steps from nonparticipants up to degrees of citizen power. The ladder's metaphor indicates the level of citizens' power in participating in public plans or programmes. The ladder ranges from manipulation (citizens have no power over decisions but participate in the process) up to citizen control, where 'participants or residents can govern a programme or an institution, be in full charge of policy and managerial aspects, and be able to negotiate the conditions under which "outsiders" may change them' (Arnstein 1969, 223). This metaphor is similar to the matrix proposed in the stakeholder theory that uses power versus interest dimensions. One tool that assesses the degree of power and interest a stakeholder can have is mentioned by Bryson (2004, 30): high power and high interest indicate a player stakeholder, while low power and low interest indicate a crowd stakeholder.

The other article in this block is Mitchell et al. (1997), who contributed to the stakeholder theory with stakeholder identification and salience elements. Freeman (1984) suggested that what makes a person, group, or organization become a stakeholder is their degree of interest in the organization's objectives, products, and activities and their power to influence the organization to make the best of their

relationship with it. Mitchell and friends contributed to improving stakeholder identification and salience by indicating a third dimension: legitimacy. For these authors, a stakeholder has power, urgency (their interpretation of interest), and legitimacy in their relationships with the organization. Therefore, instead of four types as suggested by Freeman (1984) and Eden and Ackermann (1998), these authors suggested the existence of seven stakeholders: dormant (power), discretionary (legitimacy), demanding (urgency), dominant (power and legitimacy), dangerous (power and urgency), dependent (urgency and legitimacy), and definitive (power, urgency, and legitimacy). According to them, this is a ladder that organizations can use to identify the stakeholders they need to watch and those they could invite to engage in activities.

The two articles represent the theoretical line of how public organizations should prioritize their decision-making and policy-making processes. Leaving these stakeholders aside from their activities will reduce the odds of success and create breaches of legitimacy and legal problems. We think the two articles, combined with Freeman's dimensions of power, have the potential to help organizations create mechanisms to promote engagement and, therefore, improve performance. The problem we see with Mitchell et al.'s model is the difficulty of creating importance levels for each stakeholder. The dimensions of power, urgency, and legitimacy are constructs likely to be measured, but this could make the effort complex and less worth trying to implement in real life. For example, what is a feasible and objective measure to assess a stakeholder's power to hinder a public policy from being implemented? And about legitimacy? Can it be scaled? These are questions to be answered by further investigations.

### *Sources of legitimacy*

As mentioned in the last section, legitimacy is also a dimension under which stakeholder identification and salience must be analysed. We found a very strong correlation (.74) between the works of DiMaggio and Powell (1983) and Suchman (1995). In a celebrated article written 40 years ago, DiMaggio and Powell (1983) advocated the idea that organizations seek ways to improve their performance, but they end up looking very similar to their counterparts. They used the concept of isomorphism, as a phenomenon that explains environmental forces that make unities 'resemble other units that face the same set of environmental conditions' (DiMaggio and Powell 1983, 149). Instead of rebelling against those external environmental forces, organizations adopt them because, in parallel with resources and customers, an organization also needs political power and institutional legitimacy (DiMaggio and Powell 1983). But what does a stakeholder have to do with this game? Stakeholders (they do not use this term) are those environmental actors able to exert coercive, mimetic, and normative forces upon the organization, making it behave differently from the planned.

The other article is a seminal piece dealing with legitimacy and was written by Mark Suchman in 1995. Reviewing the literature, the author identifies 'three primary forms of legitimacy: pragmatic, based on audience self-interest; moral, based on normative approval; and cognitive, based on comprehensibility and taken-for-grantedness' (Suchman 1995, 571). One relevant contribution of the article is exactly the definition it offers:

> Legitimacy is a generalized perception or assumption that the actions of an entity are desirable, proper, or appropriate within some socially constructed system of norms, values, beliefs, and definitions. (Suchman 1995, 574)

According to the definition, a moral and legal system of rules and regulations controls an organization's functioning. There will be consequences if it disrespects or disobeys any of the rules and regulations established by such a system. The other consequences defined by legitimacy relate to the organization's continuity and credibility. The connection between legitimacy tenets and stakeholder theory seems to be related to the actors able to define rules and regulations, to whom the organization has the moral obligation to perform the activities that are acceptable for the society (Suchman 1995). Andrades et al. (2021, 531) make a connection between the two theories, suggesting that

> Pragmatic legitimacy is achieved when the organization satisfies the expectations of its most immediate stakeholders... Moral legitimacy is achieved when any organization adopts an action that is seen as the right thing to do... Cognitive legitimacy refers to those actions that are accepted in society, and they are commonly represented as taken-for-granted initiatives.

### *Wicked policy problems*

The last block of theories supporting PAST is one article published by Rittel and Webber (1973), which has no relevant correlation with the other articles. This article elaborates on the policy problems public organizations deal with regularly, and they are wicked or tame problems. The authors advocated the complexity surrounding public policy issues at that time, exactly fifty years ago. Therefore, there needed to be more meaning in thinking about optimum solutions for wicked public problems, which required flexible and unstable perspectives. They suggested three approaches to deal with wicked policy problems at that time: goal formulation, problem definition, and planning problems.

But what wicked policy problems have to do with the stakeholder theory? Authors have cited Rittel and Webber's work using its classic definition of the wicked problem. However, some have elaborated on their ideas to propose including stakeholder analysis and stakeholder engagement as possible solutions for these types of problems. Head (2022) argued that wicked problems and big issues are often subject to the debate of politicians and powerful stakeholders, and they often use other ways to ensure they have a word, and their interests are attended to. Therefore, stakeholders are key actors in the process of dealing with and finding solutions for wicked problems. This indicates that public problems are now understood as complex rather than wicked and unsolvable (Broekema, Horlings, and Bulder 2022). Bryson et al. (2002, 569–570) provided a detailed interpretation of wicked problems as those with no definitive problem formulation; a problem not to be solved but re-solved again; solutions not true or false but good or bad; consequences of the solutions could not be ever known; there is no one-shot solution; the problem can be a symptom of another problem.

### *Wrapping up the findings: avenues for further investigations*

Figure 4 summarizes the contributions of the most relevant cited references to PAST.

Looking at Figure 4 and computing CRs, the strong influence comes from the Collaborative Governance field. The second most influential is related to the process of identifying stakeholders and assessing their relevance to policy and decision-making. The third most influential is dedicated to evaluating the legitimacy of stakeholder claims and from where institutional pressures come from. Finally, our analysis detected the influence of a piece dedicated to depicting how complex and wicked policy problems can be and what organizations should do to deal with them.

### *Are stakeholders more relevant to policy-making rather than to performance management?*

Cross-analysing the references, we see a clear division between policy-making and strategic management. While one set of articles is dedicated to identifying stakeholder influences to create more effective public policies, the other helps identify stakeholders as sources of power and interest in strategic and performance management. On the one hand, Ansell and Gash (2008), Bingham et al. (2005), Emerson et al. (2012), Bryson et al. (2006), Rittel and Webber (1973), and (Arnstein 1969) are pieces dedicated to policy making and to issue management. On the other hand, Bryson (2004), DiMaggio and Powell (1983), Mitchell et al. (1997), Provan and Kenis (2007), and Suchman (1995) are pieces dedicated to explaining how external resource dependence and institutional forces can shape organizational performance and behaviour. This is evidence that the literature has been more dedicated to developing public policy theories rather than strategic management. This conclusion confronts Freeman's overall aim when writing his book published in 1984: a search for 'new concepts, tools and techniques, and new theories' (Freeman 1984, 1) if US organizations are to be successful in that time's business environment. This conclusion leads us to a question that deserves attention from scholars: is stakeholder theory in the public administration domain a public policy issue rather than a body of knowledge dedicated to improving organizational performance?

If we expand the most relevant CRs beyond the ten most cited, we will find some other relevant documents dedicated to policy analysis: Kingdon (2014) and Sabatier (1988) are some good examples of the concern of making public organizations better on policy-making rather than on performance management. Looking at the author's keywords, any combination of the word performance represents 1,26% of the total number of keywords. As a matter of comparison, the total of keywords mentioning any combination with policy totals 6%. We instruct the research agenda based on this evidence. Picking up from the other literature review we demonstrated before, we should now stimulate more studies dedicated to describing stakeholder influences on public organizations' performance.

For example, Sarturi et al. (2023, 14) suggested that 'the public management sector can appropriate systems to measure and control performance related to the responses given to the interests of stakeholders and the communication of the results achieved'. We go a step ahead suggesting that besides using stakeholder information to control performance and inform stakeholders, these measures could be used as independent variables to connect with performance in a regression study. There are not many studies using stakeholder influence as an independent variable. One exception is Gomes et al. (2022), who used stakeholder influence to predict resource allocation in local governments. However, their study focuses on process rather than on outcomes

and also on educational services. In this study, the number of articles that have used performance as keywords is very small compared to using the term in for-profit organizations. Therefore, this seems to be a promising avenue to explore Freeman's assumption that stakeholders have power and interest in an organization's behaviour and performance.

### *Is stakeholder analysis useful for any public organization?*

Following Pedrini and Ferri (2019), who carried out a systematic literature review on stakeholders but whose focus was not on public administration, studies need to consider the size of the organization and their nature. According to them, stakeholder theory may profit from differences between large and small organizations and the type of service/product they produce. The list of stakeholders resulting from these studies, as well as the sort of power and relationship formed between them and the organization, is likely to take stakeholder theory to a different level. In this study, we found evidence that institutional external pressures are relevant concepts to help policy-makers find the best way to engage and include stakeholders in policy-making. However, the counterpoint of the institutional theory when dealing with institutional processes, which, according to Oliver (1991) is the resource dependence theory, is scarcely used to depict the relationships formed between public organizations and their stakeholders. This gap has been pointed out by Beck and Storopoli (2021) as a result of a literature review to identify the stakeholder's role in urban strategy and management. We suggest using resource-based theories to explain why stakeholders approach an organization and what type of influence they are able to exert. Another set of interesting independent variables will arise from these studies.

### *Public sector stakeholder theory and value creation*

Value creation is an underdeveloped concept which deserves attention from public administration scholars. Looking at the for-profit literature, the need for more studies on value creation was suggested by Freeman (2010) when he analysed the production for the last 30 years. Tantalo and Priem (2016) went in the same direction, arguing that the difficulty in creating a more stable value creation concept is due to the difficulty of balancing stakeholders' and shareholders' different needs and goals. If this is difficult in for-profit organizations, one can imagine how to deal with these issues in the public sector.

Beck and Storopoli (2021) called attention to the need for further investigations into value creation in urban contexts to reach a consensus between stakeholders and policy-makers. This suggestion aligns with what Ansell and Gash (2008) recommended fifteen years ago, but it still needs to be consolidated among scholars. For example, scanning the database, we could find only 10 articles that used 'value creation' in their abstracts and five in their titles among more than two thousand documents. Moore (2013) defines public value as something the government produces to provide well-being for the whole society, ensuring that social justice is ensured. He defines public value under three aspects: collective (whole society) + utilitarian (well-being) + deontological (social justice). Therefore, we need more investigations at least to start knowing how many stakeholders public organizations have in their ecosystems. On this particular issue, Osborne et al. (2022) suggested that public services are composed of four levels: macro or institutional, meso or level of service, micro or individual, and sub-micro. The macro level includes the whole set of rules, regulations, and norms under which

public organizations produce value for the whole society (the whole country and the rules created by the legislative, put to practice by the executive, and ensured by the judiciary). The meso level comprises each focal organization with actors, networks, and processes. The micro level includes 'service users, staff, and other key stakeholders' (Osborne et al. 2022, 640). Finally, at the sub-micro level, there are individual beliefs and values. Besides being mentioned by the authors only at the micro level, if we use Savage et al. (1991) definition, the number of stakeholders to be managed will likely escalate, which could bring problems to the value creation equation. Therefore, we need more investigations to depict the number of stakeholders involved in public value creation, what they want from the organization, and how the organization would deal with them as part of its ecosystem, as recently suggested by Sarturi et al. (2023).

> Primary stakeholders are those who have formal, official, or contractual relationships and have a direct and necessary economic impact upon the organization. Secondary stakeholders are diverse and include those who are not directly engaged in the organization's economic activities but are able to exert influences or are affected by the organization. (Savage et al. 1991, 62)

## Final words

This literature review aims to depict how public administration authors have used stakeholder theory in their articles to build the intellectual structure in the field. We reviewed articles collected in the WoS database using the term 'stakeholder' as a search topic, limiting the results to articles published in the public administration category and written in English. The bibliometric analysis suggested the predominance of some references guiding authors' minds and forming the intellectual structure of this particular body of theory. Lexical analysis helped to depict the most recurrent terms used in the ten most influential CRs. Using Kernel Canonical Correlation Analysis (KCCA), we formed a theoretical framework that indicates that the literature is composed of ideas from Collaborative Governance, Stakeholder Salience, Legitimacy, and Wicked Public Problems. We did not expect to be final in depicting the whole mosaic of theories used in PAST, but we are sure these are the most relevant ideas behind the extant literature.

From these ideas, this investigation concludes that the stakeholder theory in the public organization's domain has turned much more into a theoretical body looking for means to identify and involve stakeholders in public policy and decision-making rather than the original idea that stakeholders are those whose support an organization needs to exist (Freeman 1984). Besides being seen as an amicable relationship formed between an organization and those claimants in its environment, the older view placed organizations and stakeholders in opposite corners of the boxing rings. Stakeholders were seen as opponents, ones to be vigilant and afraid of. In the case of public organizations, due to their nature and because some legal frameworks protect them, stakeholders can be seen as allies, someone who could come to the ring to help and support to find the best possible decision. This 'new' perspective challenges quite a lot in how we see stakeholders and how public organizations could approach them. This 'new' perspective is quite clear in the collaborative governance theory.

The main limitation of this article, which has a negligible impact on its results, is that references were collected from the Clarivate Web of Science

database and focused on articles, leaving aside books and conference articles. For the first limitation, we have many articles published in top-quality journals using the same database without prejudice to their conclusions and theoretical contributions (Chandra and Walker 2019; George, Walker, and Monster 2019). For the second limitation, we have in our defence that a blind peer-review process, which is the modus operandi of the most celebrated journals, is able to improve the quality of the articles published due to 'its function as a safeguard to detect errors or unwarranted assertions, to improve quality, and to ensure standards' (McCormack 2009, 60). Besides these two limitations related to gathering references, there would be a concern about using the word stakeholder, which does not always have to do with the stakeholder theory. This was not a problem in our article, but other scholars would need to create mechanisms to avoid articles that do not contribute to this theory. Another limitation is that we have used only the ten most relevant CRs. By using natural language analysis and with patience to download more PDF files, this analysis could be extended, but we doubt the results would disprove what we have presented in this article.

## Disclosure statement

No potential conflict of interest was reported by the author(s).

## Funding

We want to acknowledge the financial support provided by the National Council of National Council for Scientific and Technological Development (Conselho Nacional de Desenvolvimento Científico e Tecnológico – CNPq) [Grant number 305497/2019-7].

## References

Ackermann, F., and C. Eden. 2011. "Strategic Management of Stakeholders: Theory and Practice [Article]." *Long Range Planning* 44 (3): 179–196. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.lrp.2010.08.001.

Al-Manji, S., J. Lovett, and G. Mitchell. 2021. "Factors Affecting Disaster Resilience in Oman: Integrating Stakeholder Analysis and Fuzzy Cognitive Mapping [Article]." *Risk, Hazards & Crisis in Public Policy* 12 (1): 29–50. https://doi.org/10.1002/rhc3.12201.

Andrades, J., M. Larran, M. J. Muriel, M. Y. Calzado, and M. P. L. Sancho. 2021. "Online Sustainability Disclosure by Spanish Hospitals: An Institutionalist Approach [Article]." *International Journal of Public Sector Management* 34 (5): 529–545. https://doi.org/10.1108/ijpsm-09-2020-0259.

Ansell, C., and A. Gash. 2008. "Collaborative Governance in Theory and Practice." *Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory* 18 (4): 543–571. https://doi.org/10.1093/jopart/mum032.

Aria, M., and C. Cuccurullo. 2017. "Bibliometrix: An R-Tool for Comprehensive Science Mapping Analysis." *Journal of Informetrics* 11 (4): 959–975. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.joi.2017.08.007.

Arnstein, S. R. 1969. "A Ladder Of Citizen Participation." *Journal of the American Institute of Planners* 35 (4): 216–224. https://doi.org/10.1080/01944366908977225.

Baminiwatta, A., and I. Solangaarachchi. 2021. "Trends and Developments in Mindfulness Research Over 55 Years: A Bibliometric Analysis of Publications Indexed in Web of Science." *Mindfulness* 12 (9): 2099–2116. https://doi.org/10.1007/s12671-021-01681-x.

Beck, D., and J. Storopoli. 2021. "Cities Through the Lens of Stakeholder Theory: A Literature Review." *Cities* 118:103377. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cities.2021.103377.

Benigno, G. O. L., D. M. Vieira, and J. E. de Oliveira. 2021. "Gender Gap in Brazilian States and Stakeholder Analysis of the National Council for Women's Rights [Article]." *Revista de Administracao Publica* 55 (2): 483–501. https://doi.org/10.1590/0034-761220190398.

Benoit, K., K. Watanabe, H. Wang, P. Nulty, A. Obeng, S. Müller, and A. Matsuo. 2018. "Quanteda: An R Package for the Quantitative Analysis of Textual Data." *Journal of Open Source Software* 3 (30): 774–774. https://doi.org/10.21105/joss.00774.

Bingham, L. B., T. Nabatchi, and R. O'Leary. 2005. "The New Governance: Practices and Processes for Stakeholder and Citizen Participation in the Work of Government [Article]." *Public Administration Review* 65 (5): 547–558. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1540-6210.2005.00482.x.

Broekema, P. M., L. G. Horlings, and E. Bulder. 2022. "Tackling Societal Challenges Together Co-Creation Strategies and Social Innovation in EU Policy and Funded Projects(sic)(sic)(sic)palabras Clave [Article]." *European Policy Analysis* 8 (1): 68–86. https://doi.org/10.1002/epa2.1133.

Bryson, J. M. 2004. "What to Do When Stakeholders Matter: Stakeholder Identification and Analysis Techniques." *Public Management Review* 6 (1): 21–53. https://doi.org/10.1080/14719030410001675722.

Bryson, J. M. 2018. *Strategic Planning for Public and Non-Profit Organization: A Guide to Strengthening and Sustaining Organizational Achievement*. 5th ed. San Francisco, CA.

Bryson, J. M., B. C. Crosby, and M. M. Stone. 2006. "The Design and Implementation of Cross-Sector Collaborations: Propositions from the Literature." *Public Administration Review* 66 (s1): 44–55. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1540-6210.2006.00665.x.

Bryson, J. M., G. L. Cunningham, and K. J. Lokkesmoe. 2002. "What to Do When Stakeholders Matter: The Case of Problem Formulation for the African American Men Project of Hennepin County Minnesota [Article; Proceedings Paper]." *Public Administration Review* 62 (5): 568–584. https://doi.org/10.1111/1540-6210.00238.

Chandra, Y., and R. M. Walker. 2019. "How Does a Seminal Article in Public Administration Diffuse and Influence the Field? Bibliometric Methods and the Case of Hood's "A Public Management for All Seasons?"." *International Public Management Journal* 22 (5): 712–742. https://doi.org/10.1080/10967494.2018.1498817.

Colebrook, P., and J. D. Dennison. 1991. "Conflict, Competition and Compromise – Collective Bargaining in the Colleges of British Columbia [Article]." *Journal of Collective Negotiations in the Public Sector* 20 (4): 259–279. (//WOS:A1991HA13200001). https://doi.org/10.2190/WT11-MGRD-2YEF-A3QM.

DiMaggio, P. J., and W. W. Powell. 1983. "The Iron Cage Revisited: Institutional Isomorphism and Collective Rationality in Organizational Fields." *American Sociological Review* 48 (2): 147–160. https://doi.org/10.2307/2095101.

Ding, Y., E. Yan, A. Frazho, and J. Caverlee. 2009. "PageRank for Ranking Authors in Co-Citation Networks." *Journal of the American Society for Information Science and Technology* 60 (11): 2229–2243. https://doi.org/10.1002/asi.21171.

Drori, I., and C. Weizmann. 2007. "Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin Against the Settlers: A Stakeholder Analysis [Article]." *Public Administration Review* 67 (2): 302–314. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1540-6210.2007.00720.x.

Eden, C., and F. Ackermann. 1998. *Making Strategy: The Journey of Strategic Management*. London, UK.

Emerson, K., T. Nabatchi, and S. Balogh. 2012. "An Integrative Framework for Collaborative Governance [Article]." *Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory* 22 (1): 1–29. https://doi.org/10.1093/jopart/mur011.

Freeman, R. E. 1984. *Strategic Management: A Stakeholder Approach*. Boston, Massachessets.

Freeman, R. E. 2010. "Managing for Stakeholders: Trade-Offs or Value Creation." *Journal of Business Ethics* 96 (S1): 7–9. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10551-011-0935-5.

Gomes, R., Liddle, J., and de Oliveira Miranda Gomes, L. 2010. "Cross-Cultural Analysis of Stakeholder Identification in Municipal Districts." *Public Management Review*, 12 (1): 53–75. https://doi.org/10.1080/14719030902800218.

George, B., R. M. Walker, and J. Monster. 2019. "Does Strategic Planning Improve Organizational Performance? A Meta-Analysis." *Public Administration Review* 79 (6): 810–819. https://doi.org/10.1111/puar.13104.

Gomes, Osborne and Guarnieri. 2020. "Stakeholder Influence and Local Government Performance: A Systematic Literature Review." *Revista de Administracao Publica* 54 (3): 448–467. https://doi.org/10.1590/0034-761220180256x.

Gomes, R. C., S. P. Osborne, and E. Lisboa. 2022. "The Myth of Mayoral Leadership in Local Government Resource Allocation: A Multilevel Analysis with Brazilian Municipalities [Article]." *Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory* 32 (3): 561–575. https://doi.org/10.1093/jopart/muab049.

Hair, J. F., and B. J. Babin. 2018. *Multivariate Data Analysis*. Cengage. https://books.google.com.tr/books?id=0R9ZswEACAAJ.

Head, B. W. 2022. *Wicked Problems in Public Policy*. Gewerbertrasse, Switzerland.

Huang, Y. Q., and S. R. Han. 2022. "Explaining Social Insurance Participation: The Importance of the Social Construction of Target Groups in China [Article]." *Policy Studies* 43 (3): 578–598. https://doi.org/10.1080/01442872.2020.1865529.

Kingdon, J. W. 2014. *Agendas, Alternatives, and Public Policies*. London, UK.

Lawrence, J. E. S., and T. J. Cook. 1982. "Designing Program Evaluations with the Help of Stakeholders [Article]." *Journal of Policy Analysis and Management* 2 (1): 120–123. https://doi.org/10.2307/3323657.

Leydesdorff, L. 2007. "Betweenness Centrality as an Indicator of the Interdisciplinarity of Scientific Journals." *Journal of the American Society for Information Science and Technology* 58 (9): 1303–1319. https://doi.org/10.1002/asi.20614.

Liu, X., J. Bollen, M. L. Nelson, and H. Van De Sompel. 2005. "Co-Authorship Networks in the Digital Library Research Community." *Information Processing & Management* 41 (6): 1462–1480. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ipm.2005.03.012.

McCormack, N. 2009. "Peer Review and Legal Publishing: What Law Librarians Need to Know About Open, Single-Blind, and Double-Blind Reviewing." *Law Library Journal* 101 (1): 59–70. https://heinonline.org/HOL/Ph=hein.journals/llj101&i=59https://heinonline.org/HOL/PrintRequesthandle=hein.journals/llj101&collection=journals&div=7&id=59&print=section&section=7(70).

Meyer, J. W., and B. Rowan. 1977. "Institutionalized Organizations: Formal Structure as Myth and Ceremony." *The American Journal of Sociology* 83 (2): 340–363. https://doi.org/10.1086/226550.

Mitchell, Agle and Wood. 1997. "Toward a Theory of Stakeholder Identification and Salience: Defining the Principle of Who and What Really Counts." *The Academy of Management Review* 22 (4): 853–886. https://doi.org/10.2307/259247.

Moore, M. H. 2013. *Recognizing Public Value*. Harvard University Press. https://doi.org/10.4159/harvard.9780674067820.

Nisonger, T. E. 2008. "The "80/20 Rule" and Core Journals." *The Serials Librarian* 55 (1–2): 62–84. https://doi.org/10.1080/03615260801970774.

Oliver, C. 1991. "Strategic Responses to Institutional Processes." *The Academy of Management Review* 16 (1): 145–179. https://doi.org/10.2307/258610.

Osborne, S. P., M. Powell, T. Cui, and K. Strokosch. 2022. "Value Creation in the Public Service Ecosystem: An Integrative Framework." *Public Administration Review* 82 (4): 634–645. https://doi.org/10.1111/puar.13474.

Pedrini, M., and L. M. Ferri. 2019. "Stakeholder Management: A Systematic Literature Review." *Corporate Governance the International Journal of Business in Society* 19 (1): 44–59. https://doi.org/10.1108/cg-08-2017-0172.

Provan, K. G., and P. Kenis. 2007. "Modes of Network Governance: Structure, Management, and Effectiveness." *Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory* 18 (2): 229–252. https://doi.org/10.1093/jopart/mum015.

Provan, K. G., and Kenis, P. 2008. "Modes of Network Governance: Structure, Management, and Effectiveness." *Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory*, 18 (2): 229–252 https://doi.org/10.1093/jopart/mum015.

Rahman, M. M. 2021. "Achieving Sustainable Development Goals of Agenda 2030 in Bangladesh: The Crossroad of the Governance and Performance [Article]." *Public Administration and Policy-An Asia-Pacific Journal* 24 (2): 195–211. https://doi.org/10.1108/pap-12-2020-0056.

Rittel, H. W. J., and M. M. Webber. 1973. "Dilemmas in a General Theory of Planning." *Policy Sciences* 4 (2): 155–169. https://doi.org/10.1007/bf01405730.

Rowley, T. J. 1997. "Moving Beyond Dyadic Ties: A Network Theory of Stakeholder Influences." *Academy of Management Review* 22 (4): 887–910. https://doi.org/10.2307/259248.

Sabatier, P. A. 1988. "An Advocacy Coalition Framework of Policy Change and the Role of Policy-Oriented Learning Therein." *Policy Sciences* 21 (2): 129–168. https://doi.org/10.1007/BF00136406.

Sarturi, Barakat and Gomes. 2023. "Stakeholder Theory in the Public Sector Domain: A Bibliometric Analysis and Future Research Agenda." *Review of Policy Research, Forthcoming*. https://doi.org/10.1111/ropr.12560.

Savage, G. T., T. W. Nix, C. J. Whitehead, and J. D. Blair. 1991. "Strategies for Assessing and Managing Organizational Stakeholders." *Academy of Management Executive* 5 (2): 61–75. https://doi.org/10.5465/ame.1991.4274682.

Selznick, P. 1966. *TVA and the Grass Roots: A Study in the Sociology of Formal Organization*. Harper Berkeley, California.

Suchman, M. C. 1995. "Managing Legitimacy: Strategic and Institutional Approaches." *Academy of Management Review* 20 (3): 571–610. https://doi.org/10.2307/258788.

Tantalo, C., and R. L. Priem. 2016. "Value Creation Through Stakeholder Synergy." *Strategic Management Journal* 37 (2): 314–329. https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.2337.

Thompson, D. F., and C. K. Walker. 2015. "A Descriptive and Historical Review of Bibliometrics with Applications to Medical Sciences." *Pharmacotherapy: The Journal of Human Pharmacology and Drug Therapy* 35 (6): 551–559. https://doi.org/10.1002/phar.1586.

Vinokourov, A., N. Cristianini, and J. Shawe-Taylor. 2002. "Inferring a Semantic Representation of Text via Cross-Language Correlation Analysis." *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems* 15.

Vogel, R., and W. H. Güttel. 2013. "The Dynamic Capability View in Strategic Management: A Bibliometric Review." *International Journal of Management Reviews* 15 (4): 426–446. https://doi.org/10.1111/ijmr.12000.

Wagner-Döbler, R. 1996. "Two Components of a Causal Explanation of Bradford's Law." *Journal of Information Science* 22 (2): 125–132. https://doi.org/10.1177/016555159602200206.

Yeleliere, E., A. B. Nyamekye, P. Antwi-Agyei, and E. F. Boamah. 2022. "Strengthening Climate Adaptation in the Northern Region of Ghana: Insights from a Stakeholder Analysis [Article]." *Climate Policy* 22 (9–10): 1169–1185. https://doi.org/10.1080/14693062.2022.2134085.

Zaidman-Zait, A. 2014. "Content Analysis." In *Encyclopedia of Quality of Life and Well-Being Research*, edited by A. C. Michalos, 1258–1261. Dordrecht, The Netherlands. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-94-007-0753-5_552.

Zupic, I., and T. Čater. 2015. "Bibliometric Methods in Management and Organization." *Organizational Research Methods* 18 (3): 429–472. https://doi.org/10.1177/1094428114562629.